

IS WAR AN OUTLET FOR RAGE?

Some scholars believe that war is human nature. Throughout history, young men have been the group most prone to aggression. In the past, large numbers of them were sent away to fight in wars. In peacetime, national service was the norm for adolescent males in some countries, and this taught them discipline and provided a clear focus for their aggression. Today, the balance has shifted, and it is not only men who serve their countries in war. Many women now fight as soldiers in their national armies. For example, females can serve on the frontline in the Israeli Defense Force (IDF).

DOES

ANY GOOD EVER COME FROM WAR?

Under certain circumstances, war may be the only way to resolve a conflict. In a few cases, it can bring an end to an injustice. War can also give an economic boost to a country or a political boost to an unpopular leader. Technological advances, from cell phones to innovations in medicine, are the result of war. A key example is the V-2 rocket, which was developed as a weapon in World War II. After the war, the V-2 was evolved and adapted for use in space programs. Instruments replaced explosives and V-2 technology became part of exploratory missions to space.

WHAT IS BAD ABOUT WAR?

Where to begin? The number of lives lost in conflicts, as well as those left with a permanent disability, is countless. Many millions of civilians and animals caught up in the chaos also die. From a financial perspective, war is very costly and can deplete a nation's finances. It causes widespread damage to the national infrastructure, including schools, hospitals, factories, and transportation, and people's homes are devastated. What is usually completely unacceptable can become routine during wartime, and war often involves atrocities such as prisoner abuse. The chaos and carnage can lead to lifelong psychiatric distress for soldiers. And can there ever be justification for deliberately destroying lives?

